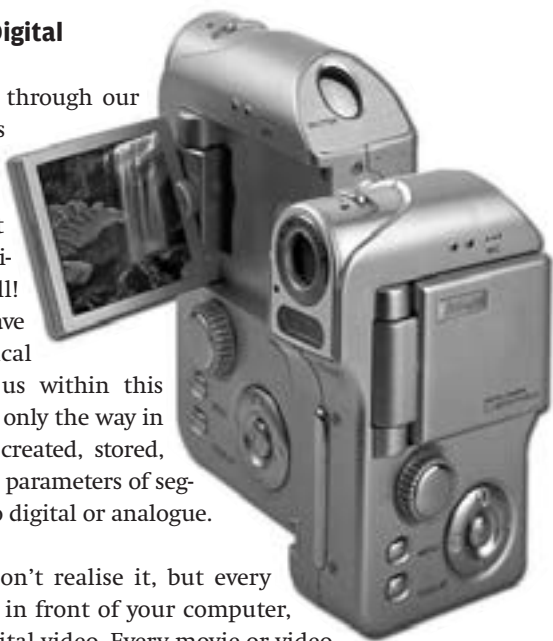


Where Do I See Digital Video?

Since we only see through our eyes, and our eyes are analogue video receivers, one could say that you NEVER see digital video at all! However, we'll leave such philosophical thoughts behind us within this book and consider only the way in which videos are created, stored, or displayed as the parameters of segregating them into digital or analogue.



Most people don't realise it, but every second you spend in front of your computer, you are seeing digital video. Every movie or video clip you watch on your computer is digital video; every DVD you pop into the DVD player or DVD-ROM drive is an instance of digital video; the same goes for VCDs, and the MMSes you send and receive; even animated GIF files on the Internet are the same, as are streaming movies or clips. The list is endless.

Even satellite television is transmitted today using digital signals, which are converted to analogue at your cable-provider's premises, before being transmitted to you. Perhaps our only interaction with analogue video today is when watching a movie in a theatre and when watching or recording videos video cassette players or cameras.

How Does A Computer Display Digital Video?

This is perhaps the most basic of questions that all of us want to know. Let's start with how a computer displays data on the monitor: